

Rigid-body contact in combined velocity and momentum notation

Symbolic mechanics, directional impulses and coupled matrix calculations

Viktor's notation: $r\wedge$, $\ell\omega$ and L/ℓ

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Abstract

We combine linear velocity and length-scaled angular velocity in a single vector, and combine linear momentum and reciprocally scaled angular momentum in its dual. A baseline wedge denotes the cross-product matrix; moving the wedge to the other side denotes its transpose. The resulting additive matrix chains include both the moment of the linear impulse and an independent angular impulse. We derive the contact response, its two-body and simultaneous-contact assembly, kinetic-energy balance, and matrix-free evaluation in two and three dimensions. Sliding and spin directions follow the relative motions rather than an arbitrary contact basis. Numerical results are omitted pending recalculation with the intended directional contact law.

1 Notation and scope

Lowercase p is linear momentum; uppercase L is angular momentum. Lowercase δ denotes an impulse, and component indices are lowercase. Uppercase V , P and F denote combined motion, momentum and force vectors. The fixed reference length is ℓ ; it is not a material coefficient. Vectors and matrices use plain symbols, with their roles and dimensions established by context. A single index k identifies a body when needed. Relative contact quantities need no pair index; participating body contributions are summed.

The direction t follows relative velocity at the collision point, and s follows relative angular velocity. They are motion-defined directions, not two axes chosen to complete a tangent basis. The contact normal is n . The allowed directional impulse components must be respected; a linear spin component δp_s is not introduced.

The directional impulse labels are δp_n , δp_t , δL_s and δL_n . The normal and sliding linear impulses are distinct from the spin and normal angular impulses.

The mechanics derived here is exact for a configuration frozen during an instantaneous impulse. It maps an allowed contact impulse to motion; it does not, by itself, determine the impulse. The original directional restitution and friction equations must close that calculation. Where those equations have not been recovered, they remain symbolic rather than being replaced by a conventional force-only law.

2 A baseline wedge for the cross-product matrix

In three dimensions define

$$r\wedge = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -r_z & r_y \\ r_z & 0 & -r_x \\ -r_y & r_x & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad r\wedge a = r \times a. \quad (1)$$

The wedge sits on the same baseline as the vector. The reversed notation denotes the transpose:

$$\wedge r = r\wedge^\top. \quad (2)$$

Here the superscript T applies to the matrix represented by $r \wedge$. Moving the wedge from right to left denotes the transpose in both dimensions. No minus-sign replacement or operand-reversal rule is used.

Matrix associativity permits chains without redundant parentheses, for example

$$\wedge r \mathbb{I}^{-1} r \wedge \delta p. \quad (3)$$

The factor order is retained. Transposition reverses a product's factor order; it does not make general matrices commute.

In two dimensions the moment map is a row and its transpose is a column:

$$r \wedge = \begin{bmatrix} -r_y & r_x \end{bmatrix}, \quad \wedge r = \begin{bmatrix} -r_y \\ r_x \end{bmatrix}. \quad (4)$$

Thus $r \wedge a = r_x a_y - r_y a_x$. The right-wedge map takes a planar linear vector to a scalar moment, while its left-wedge transpose takes a scalar angular velocity to a planar contact-velocity contribution. The same transpose notation therefore applies to rectangular planar maps and square spatial maps.

3 Combined body velocity, momentum and force

Let m be mass, $\mathbb{I}$ the world-frame central inertia, v the centre-of-mass velocity and ω angular velocity. Define

$$V = \begin{bmatrix} v \\ \ell \omega \end{bmatrix}, \quad P = \begin{bmatrix} p \\ L/\ell \end{bmatrix}, \quad M = \begin{bmatrix} m & 0 \\ 0 & \mathbb{I}/\ell^2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \boxed{P = MV}. \quad (5)$$

The combined force and its impulse are

$$F = \begin{bmatrix} f \\ \tau/\ell \end{bmatrix}, \quad \delta P = \int F dt, \quad (6)$$

where τ is the torque about the centre of mass for this body-level expression. Work and kinetic energy retain their physical values:

$$V^{\mathsf{T}} F = v^{\mathsf{T}} f + \omega^{\mathsf{T}} \tau, \quad E = \frac{1}{2} V^{\mathsf{T}} M V. \quad (7)$$

In planar motion the vectors have three components, the angular quantities are scalars, and $M = \text{diag}(m, m, \mathbb{I}/\ell^2)$.

A change of fixed representation length must leave the physical velocity, impulse and energy unchanged. Changing ℓ during motion would require coordinate-derivative terms and is outside this presentation. For simplicity we use one common fixed length throughout the contact assembly.

4 Contact motion and the full impulse

Let the contact reference point be x_c and the body centre be x_k . Its lever arm is $r_k = x_c - x_k$. The contact velocity is additive:

$$u_k = v_k + \omega_k \times r_k = v_k + \wedge r_k \omega_k. \quad (8)$$

Set

$$C_k = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \wedge r_k/\ell \end{bmatrix}, \quad B_k = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \wedge r_k/\ell \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (9)$$

Then the full contact motion is

$$U_k = \begin{bmatrix} u_k \\ \ell \omega_k \end{bmatrix} = B_k V_k. \quad (10)$$

At the declared contact reference, define the linear impulse δp and the independent angular impulse δL :

$$\delta p = \int f_c dt, \quad \delta L = \int \tau_c dt, \quad \delta P_c = \begin{bmatrix} \delta p \\ \delta L/\ell \end{bmatrix}. \quad (11)$$

The subscript c distinguishes this contact impulse from the body momentum increment. The independent contact angular impulse excludes the lever-arm moment, which the transpose map supplies:

$$\boxed{\delta P_k = B_k^\top \delta P_c} = \begin{bmatrix} \delta p \\ r_k \wedge \delta p/\ell + \delta L/\ell \end{bmatrix}. \quad (12)$$

Equivalently,

$$\delta p_k = \delta p, \quad \boxed{\delta L_k = r_k \wedge \delta p + \delta L}. \quad (13)$$

Here δL_k is the total body angular impulse. This distinction prevents counting the force moment twice. The associated work is

$$V_k^\top \delta P_k = U_k^\top \delta P_c = u_k^\top \delta p + \omega_k^\top \delta L. \quad (14)$$

For distributed contact traction f_σ over a patch $\mathcal{S}$ the independent angular impulse is the traction moment about the chosen reference:

$$\delta p = \int \int_{\mathcal{S}} f_\sigma dA dt, \quad \delta L = \int \int_{\mathcal{S}} x - x_c \wedge f_\sigma dA dt. \quad (15)$$

A reference shift $x'_c = x_c + a$ gives

$$r'_k = r_k + a, \quad \delta L' = \delta L - a \wedge \delta p, \quad (16)$$

leaving the total body angular impulse unchanged. This is reference bookkeeping, not a way to fit a collision outcome by moving the force point.

5 Two-body relative motion and contact mobility

Choose an orientation for the shared contact impulse. Let $\mathcal{B}$ contain the participating bodies and let σ_k be +1 or -1 according to that orientation. The opposite signs give equal and opposite transfers. The relative motion is a sum:

$$u = \sum_{k \in \mathcal{B}} \sigma_k u_k, \quad \Omega = \sum_{k \in \mathcal{B}} \sigma_k \omega_k, \quad U = \begin{bmatrix} u \\ \ell \Omega \end{bmatrix} = \sum_{k \in \mathcal{B}} \sigma_k U_k. \quad (17)$$

For stacked body variables, define the block collection and mass matrix

$$G = [\sigma_k B_k]_{k \in \mathcal{B}}, \quad M = \text{diag}_{k \in \mathcal{B}} M_k, \quad U = GV. \quad (18)$$

The impulse and motion updates are

$$\delta P = G^\top \delta P_c, \quad (19)$$

$$V^+ = V^- + M^{-1} G^\top \delta P_c, \quad (20)$$

$$\boxed{U^+ = U^- + W \delta P_c}, \quad W = G M^{-1} G^\top. \quad (21)$$

The signs square to one in the mobility. The explicit two-body matrix is

$$W = \sum_{k \in \mathcal{B}} \begin{bmatrix} 1/m_k + \wedge r_k \mathbb{I}_k^{-1} r_k \wedge & \ell \wedge r_k \mathbb{I}_k^{-1} \\ \ell \mathbb{I}_k^{-1} r_k \wedge & \ell^2 \mathbb{I}_k^{-1} \end{bmatrix}. \quad (22)$$

All products retain their order and the off-diagonal blocks couple linear and angular impulses. The matrix is symmetric positive semidefinite. A prescribed boundary contributes its known motion but zero inverse mass; its mass is not inserted as a large finite substitute.

6 Sliding and spin directions

For nonzero relative motions the definitions supplied by the model are

$$\boxed{t = u/\|u\|}, \quad \boxed{s = \Omega/\|\Omega\|}. \quad (23)$$

These definitions use relative velocity *at the collision point*, not centre-of-mass velocity. No projection onto a geometric tangent plane has been inserted. Consequently t need not be perpendicular to n , and s need not be perpendicular to either. If the original law specifies a projected sliding velocity, that projection must be recovered explicitly rather than assumed.

Write the allowed normal/sliding linear and spin/normal angular components as

$$\delta p_n = q_n n, \quad \delta p_t = q_t t, \quad \delta p = \delta p_n + \delta p_t, \quad (24)$$

$$\delta L_s = a_s s, \quad \delta L_n = a_n n, \quad \delta L = \delta L_s + \delta L_n. \quad (25)$$

The scalars q_n, q_t specify linear impulse amplitudes and a_s, a_n specify angular impulse amplitudes. Introduce the component map

$$D = \begin{bmatrix} n & t & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & s & n \end{bmatrix}, \quad \lambda = \begin{bmatrix} q_n \\ q_t \\ a_s/\ell \\ a_n/\ell \end{bmatrix}, \quad \boxed{\delta P_c = D\lambda}. \quad (26)$$

This map is not assumed orthogonal, square or invertible. Its dual gives the component-conjugate motions and coupled mobility:

$$z = D^\top U, \quad W_d = D^\top W D, \quad \boxed{z^+ = z^- + W_d \lambda}. \quad (27)$$

The transpose is a work projection, not an assertion that nonorthogonal directions are independent coordinate axes.

If a relative motion vanishes, its unit direction is undefined. Its subsequent static, sticking or onset branch must come from the contact law. Choosing an arbitrary direction and calling it sliding or spin changes the model. If s aligns with n , the two angular columns become dependent. The law must then determine their physical sum without demanding a nonsingular four-component inverse. The same issue can occur for the linear directions.

Directions evaluated before a frozen impulse give a finite matrix calculation. Directions evolving during a finite collision require state updates and force integration. Those are distinct algorithms and must not be conflated.

7 Restitution and friction as the contact closure

The mass and contact matrices specify how impulses change motion. Restitution and friction specify which impulses are applied. Keep their material parameters in a separate profile θ and express the directional law symbolically as

$$\Phi(\lambda, U^-, U^+, D, \theta, \xi) = 0, \quad \lambda \in \mathcal{C}(\theta, \xi). \quad (28)$$

Here ξ denotes contact history only if the original law retains it, and $\mathcal{C}$ denotes its physically specified admissibility conditions. These placeholders identify the missing constitutive specification; they are not a proposed new fitted law.

For any scalar motion channel to which a signed endpoint restitution condition actually applies, its symbolic target is

$$z_i^+ + e_i z_i^- = 0. \quad (29)$$

For a declared set of such channels, a frozen-direction residual has the form

$$W_d \lambda + 1 z^- + E z^- = 0, \quad (30)$$

with E containing the corresponding restitution symbols. This is a conditional matrix expression, not a statement that all four components have independently specified restitution targets. Friction limits, dependent directions or simultaneous-contact kinematics can prevent exact targets from coexisting.

Normal restitution and the historical geometric-tangent restitution must not be silently applied to a different motion-defined direction. A usual signed restitution convention means $e_i = -1$ preserves the channel velocity, $e_i = 0$ targets arrest, and $e_i > 0$ targets reversal. That convention alone establishes neither a material property nor passive coupled motion.

Sliding and angular resistance must follow the model's specified t , s and normal angular component. A translational Coulomb cone by itself supplies no independent angular impulse. Conversely, adding independent guessed moment limits or replacing the direction map by two arbitrary tangent axes changes the constitutive model. We therefore do not retain the earlier force-only endpoint solver as a definition of this law.

Separate input field	Required specification
Normal restitution	Documented material-pair value and velocity convention
Sliding restitution	Documented value and the exact relative-motion channel
Sliding friction	Original static/dynamic or endpoint rule, if present
Angular contact response	Original s and n component laws and their parameters
Geometry and state	Contact reference, normal, inertia, pose, incoming motion
Validity	Surface condition, speed/size range, uncertainties and source

No numerical material value is substituted into the symbolic derivation. Missing public inputs remain missing. No coefficients are fitted to the target collision to manufacture agreement.

8 Energy, angular momentum and moving boundaries

For two dynamic bodies with no external impulsive work, the frozen-configuration kinetic-energy change is

$$\delta E = \delta P_c^\top U^- + \frac{1}{2} \delta P_c^\top W \delta P_c. \quad (31)$$

Its linear term contains *both* impulse works:

$$\delta P_c^\top U^- = \delta p^\top u^- + \delta L^\top \Omega^-. \quad (32)$$

In the allowed component representation,

$$\delta E = \lambda^\top z^- + \frac{1}{2} \lambda^\top W_d \lambda. \quad (33)$$

For an initially unstrained passive impact require $\delta E \leq 0$. If stored elastic energy is present, include it in the ledger instead of imposing a kinetic-energy inequality in isolation. Translation alone need not conserve energy, because rotation, deformation, dissipation and support work exchange energy.

For a prescribed moving boundary the work supplied through its contact motion is

$$W_b = \delta p^\top u_b + \delta L^\top \omega_b, \quad (34)$$

and the corresponding relative-motion identity concerns $\delta E - W_b$.

Equal and opposite impulses at the shared reference conserve total linear momentum. About a world origin the angular balance uses the orbital contribution as well as central angular momentum:

$$\delta J_k = x_k \wedge \delta p_k + \delta L_k. \quad (35)$$

The pair contributions sum to zero, including the independent opposite angular impulses. Checking only the force lever-arm moment misses this mechanism.

9 Symbolic three-dimensional examples

9.1 Central normal impact with axial spin

Consider a homogeneous sphere of radius R and central inertia $\mathbb{I}$, with $r = -Rn$. Prescribe a central linear impulse and axial incoming spin:

$$\delta p = qn, \quad \omega^- = \omega^- n. \quad (36)$$

Then

$$r \wedge \delta p = 0, \quad \wedge r \omega^- = 0. \quad (37)$$

The complete angular update is therefore

$$\boxed{\delta L_k = \delta L_s + \delta L_n}, \quad \omega^+ = \omega^- + \mathbb{I}^{-1} \delta L_k. \quad (38)$$

A force-only model sets these independent angular impulses to zero and cannot change this axial spin. Here s is parallel or antiparallel to n : the component map is dependent, yet the physical total angular impulse is well defined. The contact law must determine that total. No arbitrary inversion of two collinear angular directions is required.

9.2 Rotated non-spherical body

Let a homogeneous cuboid have half-extents a, b, c , mass m , and attitude matrix Q . Its shape-frame and world inertia are

$$\mathbb{I}_0 = \frac{m}{3} \text{diag}(b^2 + c^2, a^2 + c^2, a^2 + b^2), \quad \mathbb{I} = Q \mathbb{I}_0 Q^\top. \quad (39)$$

For a supporting vertex r_0 , use $r = Qr_0$. A fixed plane gives

$$u^- = v^- + \wedge r \omega^-, \quad \Omega^- = \omega^-. \quad (40)$$

Construct t , s , the direction map and the full mobility from these physical states. Once the directional law supplies δp and δL , predict

$$\boxed{v^+ = v^- + \delta p/m}, \quad \boxed{\omega^+ = \omega^- + \mathbb{I}^{-1} r \wedge \delta p + \mathbb{I}^{-1} \delta L}. \quad (41)$$

The same formula includes spin-generated sliding, an off-centre normal force moment, and the independent angular impulse. Non-diagonal inertia couples the angular directions without adding material parameters. This is a symbolic 3D example; the earlier force-only cuboid numbers have been removed from this reading version.

10 The planar form

For one planar body, suppress the body index and write

$$V = \begin{bmatrix} v_x \\ v_y \\ \ell\omega \end{bmatrix}, \quad B = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -r_y/\ell \\ 0 & 1 & r_x/\ell \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (42)$$

The contact and body impulses are

$$\delta P_c = \begin{bmatrix} \delta p_x \\ \delta p_y \\ \delta L/\ell \end{bmatrix}, \quad \delta P_{\text{body}} = B^\top \delta P_c, \quad \delta L_{\text{body}} = r \wedge \delta p + \delta L. \quad (43)$$

The pair map, mobility and energy identities retain the same matrix forms with these planar block dimensions. Planar angular velocity and angular impulse are signed scalars. A three-dimensional normal-angular channel is restricted to the permitted planar rotation axis; it must not be inserted as an extra independent planar degree of freedom. Any component unavailable under that geometric restriction is omitted rather than independently solved.

11 Simultaneous contacts and efficient evaluation

For many bodies, stack their combined velocities and block-diagonal masses. For each oriented contact, put each signed body block $\sigma_k B_k$ in its appropriate columns. Stack the allowed component maps into $\mathcal{D}$. Define

$$H = \mathcal{D}^\top G, \quad z = HV, \quad W_d = HM^{-1}H^\top. \quad (44)$$

The whole contact system is

$$z^+ = z^- + W_d \lambda, \quad V^+ = V^- + M^{-1}H^\top \lambda. \quad (45)$$

Off-diagonal contact blocks carry impulses through shared bodies. Keeping only independent pair blocks changes rapid group motion. Disconnected contact islands may be solved separately.

The operator need not be formed densely. For a trial component vector q , apply

$$\boxed{W_d q = HM^{-1}H^\top q} \quad (46)$$

through three operations: scatter $H^\top q$ to bodies, apply each body's inverse mass and inertia solve, and gather with H . Rotation uses the world inertia $Q\mathbb{I}_0Q^\top$. Solve small inertia systems or use a rotated precomputed shape-frame inverse; avoid forming a large inverse.

The directional law selects the component unknowns and active branches. Assemble small matrices for modest islands or use iterative operator evaluations for large islands. Dependent directions and redundant contacts require rank-aware solves; a failed inverse is not repaired by silently changing the physical components. Check the full-system work and energy, not independent contact energies that omit shared-body cross terms.

12 Recalculation and comparison plan

Numerical outputs, material-value tables and prediction-error diagrams are intentionally omitted from this rewrite. Existing results remain preserved in the repository as calculations of historical comparator models. They are not results of the directional model described here.

Before new predictions, recover the exact original restitution/friction closure, its zero-motion branches, and whether directions evolve during impact. Then verify pure spin, pure sliding,

mixed motion, off-centre non-spherical impacts and coupled contact groups in both dimensions. Checks must include equal/opposite impulse, total angular momentum, dual work, energy and reference-length invariance.

Select independently documented material-pair parameters without project fitting. Missing angular response data cannot be inferred from desired output and called an independent material prediction. Public ball and rock records can then be compared using the same measured input states, with actual shape, inertia and uncertainty wherever available. Source reconstruction and held-out prediction must remain distinguishable.

For the eventual visualization, compare measured and predicted outgoing motion using the previously requested two-coordinate deviation map. Define the observation signature and its metric before inspecting agreement; state which components were independently measured. Distinct collision types can share the same error point. No dots are supplied here until the corrected model has actually been evaluated.

13 Relation to prior notation

Combined motion and dual force/momentum, power pairing and characteristic-length normalization have established precedents[5, 6, 7]. Vose and colleagues explicitly scale planar angular velocity and torque by reciprocal factors[8]; Zhang and colleagues give related deformation/moment scaling[9]. The baseline wedge here makes the cross-product transpose and additive matrix chains explicit; matrix associativity and transpose duality are established algebra.

Contact force-and-moment models and matrix-free coupled contact calculations also have prior art[12, 13, 10]. This symbolic rewrite is a presentation of the intended notation and mechanics, not a demonstrated novelty claim or a completed validation of the directional constitutive law. The separate literature review retains the source-specific findings. A publishable predictive claim requires new, reproducible evidence after the corrected model is implemented.

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